Judith Butler, the Jewish philosopher from Berkeley, in her 2013 text *Parting Ways: Jewishness and the Critique of Zionism*, has adopted the Arendtian critique of the nation-state as an "anachronism" in order to argue on ethical grounds for the dissolution of Israel as a Jewish State.[21] Butler reconnects to the deterministic claim that the Israel polity is bound to spiritually pervert Judaism. Repeatedly, in this context she invokes the false assertion that Israel *deliberately* expelled as many as 700,000 Arabs in 1948. Like so many other "progressive" Jewish anti-Zionists, she ignores the much larger number of Jews who were persecuted, expropriated, and expelled from Arab lands between 1948 and 1967. Such selective humanism, claiming to speak in the name of a universalistic Diaspora-oriented Judaism, can hardly claim to be "ethical."

Butler's anti-Zionism leads to the complete severing of any connection between the State of Israel, the Jewish people, and Jewish values.[22] Her self-declared aim is to dismantle so-called Zionist hegemony over Jewishness along with its "colonial subjugation" of the Palestinians. As with Arendt (and the late Tony Judt), the "original sin" of Zionism lies in its insistence on Jewish political sovereignty in the land of Israel and its adhesion to the nation-state model. The Zionists, needless to say, are solely responsible for the dispossession and refugee status of the Palestinian Arabs. The unlawful invasion of Israel by seven Arab states in May 1948 in order to throttle its existence at birth becomes a *non-event*.

At the heart of such Jewish leftist anti-Zionism there is an ideologically-driven desire to efface or abolish altogether the Jewish State. This radical Jewish Zionophobia (tinged with anti-Judaism and Judeophobic feelings) provides much of the legitimacy as well as the alibi for present-day antisemitsm and anti-Israelism.

After all, if even Jews and/or Israelis insist that Israel is racist, colonialist, or fascist, then surely it must be true. If they pretend that such charges are not antisemitic, it must be so. If Israeli or Diaspora Jews deny that Jews are a nation or assert that this merely a "Zionist" invention, why should anti-Israeli Gentiles challenge that assumption—especially if the Jews in question are liberals, democrats, Marxists, or so-called "progressives."? Even the outdated theories of the Belgian Jewish Trotskyist Abraham Léon—incinerated in Auschwitz in 1944—could be revived by Jewish anti-Zionists twenty-five years after his death as profound insights. For the young Léon, Zionism was an "ideological excrescence," a diversion from the great cause of proletarian revolution—which alone could save the Jewish masses. Like Trotsky, Léon considered Zionism to be the fleeting product of "capitalist decay" in the imperialist era. Even if the British or Americans were to create "some kind of

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